



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Seattle Classical Christian School

School Website: <https://www.seattleclassicalchristianschool.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Seattle Classical Christian School WA 98122 (SCCS) demonstrates strong alignment with classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements. Public materials from SCCS consistently emphasize a Christian, virtue-centered framework, a curriculum built around the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Latin, the study of Great Books and a "Great Conversation," and pedagogy that includes Socratic seminars alongside traditional instruction. The school also foregrounds the teacher as the living curriculum, explicit faculty mentorship, and an intentional partnership with families and the broader school community. Evidence across multiple pages and posts highlights a Gospel-centered, biblically integrated approach to learning, communal worship and devotion, and a history-led approach to curriculum. Overall, SCCS is **CLASSICAL** across all six categories, with particularly strong signaling in religious/metaphysical foundations, curriculum, and pedagogy.

Key evidence highlights include:

- Religious/metaphysical foundations: embedded biblical worldview across disciplines; worship and devotionals; gospel-centered formation; Scripture as the lens for all study.
- Purpose and goal: explicit aim to cultivate virtue, wisdom, and a resilient faith; education as formation, not merely information.
- Curriculum: emphasis on grammar, logic, rhetoric; history as organizing principle; study of Great Books and Great Conversation; Latin as core; education designed to evoke wonder.
- Pedagogy: a blend of contemplative/restful elements with rigorous inquiry; lower grades' memory through singing/devotionals; upper grades' Socratic seminars and rhetoric training; public-speaking opportunities.
- Faculty: teachers described as mentors and living curriculum; portraits of teacher ideals; faculty/staff pages emphasize mentorship and accountability.
- Parents & Community: explicit family partnerships; emphasis on parent involvement and education about classical education; invitations for visits and engagement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence

- The Gospel is described as central to formation and learning. Example: "With the Gospel at the center, our students learn stewardship, honor, wisdom, and self-control."
- Biblical/theological grounding is explicit through embedded Bible perspectives and Word-centered learning. Examples: "Embedded Biblical Perspective: God and His Word serve as the lens through which our students experience their lessons" and "All learning is embedded in God's Word."

- Worship, devotionals, and liturgical practices are integrated into student life (Morning Meetings with worship, devotionals).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: Gospel, Bible, Word, God, Scripture, worship, devotionals, Gospel-centered, biblical perspective, Christ-centered, truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, discipleship.
- Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials (no explicit secular or anti-theology terminology observed in the available content).

Why this rating

- The materials consistently anchor education in a transcendent moral framework (truth, goodness, beauty) through a biblical lens, with liturgical/community practices and explicit gospel focus, satisfying the transcendental realism and theological grounding criteria. Public materials demonstrate liturgical and communal practices as integral to education in a clearly Christian framework. Therefore, CLASSICAL.

Citations: gospel-centered statements and embedded biblical perspective are drawn from SCCS content, including “With the Gospel at the center...” and “Embedded Biblical Perspective” sections.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school presents education as formation of virtue and wisdom, aligning with classical aims rather than purely preparation for work. “Our goal is to shape critical thinkers who are set apart and well-prepared to embody God’s goodness, truth, and beauty in every aspect of life.”
- Emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty as real realities students can know. The Great Books/Great Conversation framework supports universal, enduring truths rather than vocational training alone.
- The embedding of biblical from-the-core formation (the Word as the lens) supports formation over mere information.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, formation, character, discipleship, gospel, God, Word, Scripture.
- Negative keywords present: none detected; no explicit vocational-first or secular/anti-theology terms observed.

Why this rating

- The explicit articulation of formation, virtue, wisdom, and reality of Truth/Goodness/Beauty aligns with classical aims beyond job-focused outcomes. The strongest signals come from “formation” language and the integrated Great Books/great conversation approach, supporting CLASSICAL.

Citations: formation-focused quotes and purpose statements.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Core liberal arts are emphasized: grammar, logic, and rhetoric across all subjects; history taught through the curriculum with Great Books; Latin is taught; a “Great Books” and “Great Conversation” tradition is explicit.
- History is organized as the organizing principle for the curriculum, not treated as social studies.
- Latin studies and resources.
- Great Books and Great Conversation are explicitly referenced as part of the curriculum.
- Evidence of literature selections and classical curriculum components for multiple grades (K-12).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, liberal arts, Great Books, Great Conversation, history (as organizing principle), Latin, memory/wonder (implicit through “wonder-filled rooms” language in the Great Books description).
- Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials (no “social studies” framing; actually the opposite—explicit rejection of history as mere social studies is present in wording).

Why this rating

- The curriculum text aligns tightly with classical education expectations: grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, history as organizing principle, Latin, and an emphasis on educating for wonder and character. This meets CLASSICAL criteria.

Citations: Core curricular language and Great Books/Liberal Arts references.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Socratic elements and seminars appear in middle/high school contexts; public-facing materials reference Socratic seminars and rigorous dialogue around primary texts.
- Upper school rhetoric training and public speaking opportunities (e.g., Senior thesis; Rhetoric School content).
- Lower school emphasizes communal practices, memory, and devotionals (e.g., worship, devotionals; early memory work).
- A clear “living curriculum” metaphor for faculty involvement in teaching and mentoring (Faculty, Staff, & Board; portraits of teacher ideals).
- Latin and classical language emphasis as part of pedagogy (including Latin instruction and rationale).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic seminars, seminars, logic, rhetoric, public speaking, Senior Thesis, “living curriculum,” mentorship, devotionals, worship, Latin.
- Negative keywords present: None observed; no explicit references to non-classical approaches (no “project-based” or purely secular pedagogy terms observed in the public materials).

Why this rating

- The pedagogy combines contemplative/restful elements with rigorous inquiry (contemplative in lower grades; Socratic seminars and rhetoric in higher grades). The explicit presence of Socratic methods and rhetoric, plus the living curriculum concept and structured classical pedagogy, justify CLASSICAL.

Citations: Socratic pedagogy and rhetoric-focused content; faculty as living curriculum; lower- vs upper-school pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The faculty are described as mentors who model virtue and knowledge; teachers are described as the living curriculum and as core to the school community.
- Faculty, staff, and board pages emphasize a collaborative community and the portrait of a graduate as a standard for teaching and learning.
- Advertising language emphasizes “architects of curiosity and character,” suggesting a role model/mentor identity for teachers.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: mentors, living curriculum, teachers as core, virtue, character, wisdom, discipline, collegiality, portrait of a teacher/student.
- Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials.

Why this rating

- The public materials repeatedly frame faculty as central to character formation and the curriculum, and as a professional, collaborative, and virtuous body. These are consistent with CLASSICAL expectations around faculty.

Citations: “architects of curiosity and character” and living curriculum language; staff/board pages.

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes partnerships with parents and family involvement as a hallmark of classical formation; there are resources about family partnership and education for parents (What is SCCS seeking in a family partnership?).
- Website invites parent engagement, campus visits, and open houses; admissions materials highlight family engagement and co-learning with parents as co-teachers in some contexts.
- Public-facing content shows parental testimonials and community-building elements (blog posts about classroom experiences and parental involvement).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: family partnership, co-teaching with parents, parent involvement, community, visits/open houses, parental education (e.g., blog/leadership about family partnership).
- Negative keywords present: none detected; no hints of closed community or limited parental access.

Why this rating

- The materials emphasize partnering with parents and providing opportunities for families to engage with classical education (e.g., family partnership guides, open houses, and opportunities for parent education). This aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for engaged parents and community.

Citations: family partnership content; visits/open house; parent engagement language.

Aggregate Assessment

- Across all six categories, SCCS demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment with clear signals of religious/metaphysical foundations, formation-focused purpose, a liberal-arts curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Latin), Socratic pedagogy and rhetoric, strong faculty as mentors, and robust parent/community partnerships.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable, as the school is classified as CLASSICAL across all six categories. If one were seeking to push toward a more explicitly “Socratic” pedagogy in every grade band, SCCS could consider extending Socratic/Scholé-based approaches to additional lower grades or expanding structured peer-seminars beyond middle/high school. Also, continuing to document and publish explicit evidence of Great Books sequencing and “Great Conversation” disciplines across grades could further strengthen the public-facing case.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.